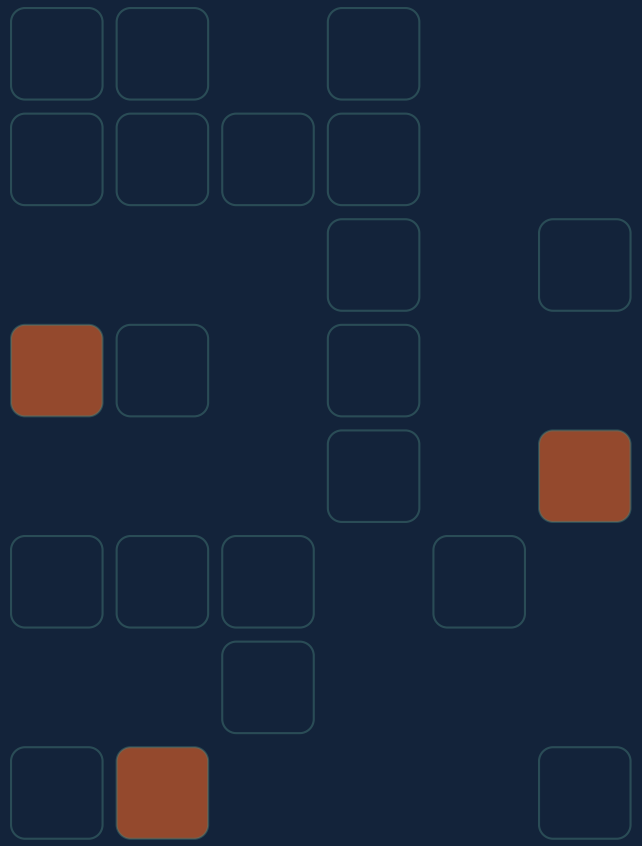
THE LSI TOOLKIT

TOOL 03 OF 04 · EVALUATION SCORECARD

LSI Evaluation Scorecard

Learning Space Integrator — Qualifications-Based Selection Rubric



Industry Standard Template • Not affiliated with any vendor or proprietary methodology

Evaluator Information and Certification

Evaluator Name	
Evaluator Role	
Firm Being Evaluated	
Date	

Conflict of Interest Certification — required before scoring. By signing, I certify that: (1) I have no financial or personal relationship with this firm or its principals that would bias my evaluation; (2) I have not received anything of value from this firm; and (3) I will score this proposal based solely on the published criteria. If you cannot make this certification, notify the committee chair and do not score this proposal.

Evaluator Signature	
Date	

How to Score

How to score	District weighting — set before issuing the solicitation
1. Read the complete proposal before scoring any criterion. 2. Score each sub-criterion from 1 to 5 using the anchor descriptions. 3. Complete your scoring independently, before the group discussion. 4. Use the Notes box under each criterion to capture specific evidence from the proposal — your notes are as important as your scores. 5. Scores of 1 or 5 should be rare; most proposals will earn 2–4. 6. Bring your completed scorecard to the evaluation meeting.	This scorecard uses nine criteria. Your district assigns the weight for each criterion before the RFQ or RFP is issued. Weights must total 100%, reflect your district's priorities, and be disclosed to all proposers in the solicitation. **Weighted score for each criterion = (raw score ÷ maximum raw score) × district weight.** The total weighted score is out of 100. The companion Excel calculator does this math automatically for up to five firms.

District Weighting

Agree on these weights as a committee before the solicitation is issued, and publish them in the solicitation. Suggested starting weights are shown; adapt them to your project using the Guide for District Weight-Setting at the end of this scorecard.

#	Criterion	Suggested Weight	Your District's Weight
1	Relevant Experience & Past Performance	15%	_____ %
2	Educational / Learning Environment Approach	15%	_____ %
3	Stakeholder Engagement & Discovery	10%	_____ %
4	Design & Planning Methodology	10%	_____ %
5	Implementation & Project Management	15%	_____ %
6	Budget, Cost Transparency & Value	10%	_____ %
7	Product Sourcing & Procurement Transparency	10%	_____ %
8	Partnership, Governance & Communication	10%	_____ %
9	Outcomes, Evaluation & Continuous Improvement	5%	_____ %
	Total	**100%**	**100%**

Criterion 1: Relevant Experience & Past Performance

Sub-criterion	1 — Does Not Meet	2 — Partially Meets	3 — Meets	4 — Exceeds	5 — Outstanding	Score
1A. Scale and volume of comparable K-12 projects	No relevant K-12 projects provided	1–2 small or only loosely related projects	2–3 projects of moderate scale and relevance	3+ projects; at least one comparable in size and complexity	5+ projects; multiple of comparable scope; clear specialization in K-12 learning environments	____
1B. Relevance of case studies to our district context	No case studies, or all unrelated to our context	Vague case studies; limited relevance	Case studies present; some connection to our district type	Strong case studies; clearly relevant to our district type and project scope	Highly specific and detailed; deep understanding of similar district contexts	____
1C. Evidence of positive outcomes from prior work	No outcomes described; only outputs listed	Outputs listed (e.g., furniture delivered) with no outcome data	Some outcome language; limited specifics	Clear outcomes with evidence; connects space to learning goals	Compelling, specific outcomes with data or qualitative evidence; long-term follow-up demonstrated	____
1D. Reference quality and strength	No references, or references unreachable	References provided but feedback generic or limited	Adequate references with standard positive feedback	Strong, specific references; referees describe the firm's approach clearly	Outstanding references; proactive detail; referees willing to host site visits	____

Raw score (sum of sub-criteria) _____ / 20 **District weight** _____ % **Weighted score** = raw ÷ 20 × weight _____

NOTES / EVIDENCE

Criterion 2: Educational / Learning Environment Approach

Sub-criterion	1 — Does Not Meet	2 — Partially Meets	3 — Meets	4 — Exceeds	5 — Outstanding	Score
2A. Vision-first vs. product-first orientation	Leads with a product catalog or standard furniture lines	Mentions educational goals but quickly pivots to products	Addresses vision; some education-centered language	Clearly starts with the district's educational goals before discussing any product or solution	Exemplary vision-first approach; deep understanding of how environment supports pedagogy	____
2B. Understanding of learning science principles	No reference to learning research or educational theory	Generic reference to "modern learning environments"	Familiarity with relevant learning science principles	Applies specific research principles to their design approach; connects to district goals	Sophisticated, nuanced application of learning environment research; references specific frameworks	____
2C. Accessibility, inclusion, and universal design	No mention of accessibility, sensory needs, or inclusion	Brief mention of ADA compliance only	Addresses accessibility and some universal design principles	Strong accessibility framework: sensory, mobility, neurodiversity, equitable access	Comprehensive universal design: sensory, neurodiversity, mobility, acoustics, and belonging all addressed	____

Raw score (sum of sub-criteria) _____ / 15 **District weight** _____ % **Weighted score** = raw ÷ 15 × weight _____

NOTES / EVIDENCE

Criterion 3: Stakeholder Engagement & Discovery

Sub-criterion	1 — Does Not Meet	2 — Partially Meets	3 — Meets	4 — Exceeds	5 — Outstanding	Score
3A. Quality of visioning / discovery process	No discovery process described; jumps to solutions	Mentions listening to stakeholders but no structured process	Describes a discovery process with some structure	Clear, structured discovery approach with specific engagement steps	Exceptional discovery methodology adaptable to our context; specific tools and facilitation approach	____
3B. Breadth and depth of stakeholder inclusion	No stakeholders mentioned beyond administration	A few stakeholders; limited breadth	Includes educators and administration; some student reference	Broad inclusion: educators, administration, students, families, community	Comprehensive framework including special education and community; student voice deliberately embedded	____
3C. Approach to surfacing and resolving disagreement	No mention of conflict or differing views	Acknowledges disagreement may occur; no approach described	Describes a general facilitation approach for disagreement	Clear approach for navigating disagreement, with examples from prior projects	Robust conflict resolution approach; specific examples of navigating difficult stakeholder dynamics	____

Raw score (sum of sub-criteria) _____ / 15 **District weight** _____ % **Weighted score** = raw ÷ 15 × weight _____

NOTES / EVIDENCE

Criterion 4: Design & Planning Methodology

Sub-criterion	1 — Does Not Meet	2 — Partially Meets	3 — Meets	4 — Exceeds	5 — Outstanding	Score
4A. Site-specific vs. generic design process	One-size-fits-all solution with no site-specific planning	Generic process; limited evidence of customization by school	Acknowledges site differences; some school-specific planning	Clear site-by-site planning approach; customization to each building described	Exceptional site-specific methodology; each school treated as a discrete, accountable project	____
4B. Integration of space, technology, and curriculum	Proposes furniture or technology in isolation	Some integration language; limited evidence of a holistic approach	Addresses integration of space, technology, and pedagogy	Strong integration framework connecting physical, digital, and instructional environments	Exemplary integrated design; shows how all elements work together to support learning	____
4C. Flexibility and adaptability of design solutions	Fixed, single-use spaces with no adaptability	Limited adaptability; mostly fixed configurations	Some flexible design elements included	Designed for multi-use, adaptable learning across instructional modes	Sophisticated flexibility framework; spaces designed to evolve with the district's pedagogy over time	____

Raw score (sum of sub-criteria) _____ / 15 **District weight** _____ % **Weighted score** = raw ÷ 15 × weight _____

NOTES / EVIDENCE

Criterion 5: Implementation & Project Management

Sub-criterion	1 — Does Not Meet	2 — Partially Meets	3 — Meets	4 — Exceeds	5 — Outstanding	Score
5A. School-by-school project accountability	No evidence of project management or site-specific accountability	Generic project management; not organized by school site	Acknowledges school-by-school structure; basic approach described	Clear site-specific approach: milestones, deliverables, and accountability per school	Comprehensive framework: each site has independent milestones, an owner, and risk management	____
5B. Budget and timeline track record	No evidence of budget or timeline discipline; history of overruns	Vague claims; no specific examples	Acknowledges budget and timeline management; limited examples	Demonstrated track record; addresses challenges transparently with specific examples	Excellent discipline; proactive risk management; examples include difficult situations	____
5C. Change management and educator adoption	No mention of change management or educator preparation	Brief mention; no specific approach	Describes change management; some professional development detail	Solid approach with specific PD examples from prior projects	Comprehensive, proven approach; PD examples with measured educator adoption outcomes	____
5D. Post-implementation support	No mention of post-implementation support	Implementation described as complete at handoff	Some post-implementation language; limited specifics	Clear post-implementation plan; follow-up support described	Structured post-occupancy support; ongoing evaluation and iteration	____

Raw score (sum of sub-criteria) _____ / 20 **District weight** _____ % **Weighted score** = raw ÷ 20 × weight _____

NOTES / EVIDENCE

Criterion 6: Budget, Cost Transparency & Value

Sub-criterion	1 — Does Not Meet	2 — Partially Meets	3 — Meets	4 — Exceeds	5 — Outstanding	Score
6A. Clarity and structure of fee proposal	No fee information provided	Vague fee description; hard to understand or compare	Fee structure described with adequate clarity	Clear fee structure organized by school, phase, and service category	Highly transparent; easy to compare; organized exactly as requested in the solicitation	____
6B. Budget realism and on-budget track record	No evidence of budget management, or known history of overruns	Vague claims; no specific examples	Budget management addressed; limited examples	Clear track record with specific on-budget examples	Excellent track record, including managing to budget in challenging situations	____
6C. Value relative to scope and team	Fee appears high relative to scope; limited justification	Fee present; limited justification of value	Adequate justification relative to experience and scope	Strong value case; fee reasonable relative to team experience and scope	Outstanding value case; fee clearly justified by team quality, experience, and scope of services	____

Raw score (sum of sub-criteria) _____ / 15 **District weight** _____ % **Weighted score** = raw ÷ 15 × weight _____

NOTES / EVIDENCE

Criterion 7: Product Sourcing & Procurement Transparency

Sub-criterion	1 — Does Not Meet	2 — Partially Meets	3 — Meets	4 — Exceeds	5 — Outstanding	Score
7A. Transparency of vendor access and relationships	No disclosure; disclosure section blank or missing	Partial disclosure; unclear which manufacturers they can or cannot access	Discloses relationships; lists manufacturers accessible and not accessible	Full, clear disclosure; explains financial relationships and how they are managed	Proactive, thorough disclosure; explains how conflicts are identified and mitigated for the district	____
7B. Objectivity of product recommendation process	No description of product selection, or a clearly product-led proposal	Vague process; limited evidence of objectivity	Describes a selection process; some objectivity language	Clear, structured process; alternatives consistently presented to districts	Explicitly objective process with independent criteria; districts confirm recommendations reflect their interests	____
7C. Disclosure of compensation structures	No mention of compensation or referral arrangements	Acknowledges compensation may exist; no specifics	Describes compensation structure with some clarity	Clear, specific disclosure; explains how the district's interests are protected	Comprehensive, proactive disclosure of all arrangements; no follow-up needed	____

Raw score (sum of sub-criteria) _____ / 15 **District weight** _____ % **Weighted score** = raw ÷ 15 × weight _____

NOTES / EVIDENCE

Criterion 8: Partnership, Governance & Communication

Sub-criterion	1 — Does Not Meet	2 — Partially Meets	3 — Meets	4 — Exceeds	5 — Outstanding	Score
8A. Responsiveness and communication approach	No communication protocols or response expectations	Vague communication language; no structure	General communication approach with some structure	Clear framework: escalation paths, response times, and meeting cadence	Comprehensive governance: protocols for communication, decisions, escalation, and continuity	____
8B. Personnel continuity and key-person risk	No continuity plan; no named staff for this project	Mentions team but not continuity or key-person risk	Addresses continuity; basic transition plan	Named, committed team; clear continuity plan for key personnel	Senior staff named and committed; succession planning addressed; confirmed by prior clients	____
8C. Evidence of genuine partnership orientation	Transactional tone; reads like a vendor pitch	Mostly transactional; some partnership language	Partnership-oriented; some evidence of collaborative work	Strong partnership orientation; examples of co-design and district-led decisions	Compelling evidence, confirmed by references; demonstrates district ownership of decisions	____
8D. Reference feedback on working relationship	No references checked, or negative feedback	References reachable but feedback minimal or generic	Standard positive feedback on the working relationship	Specific, substantive feedback on communication and collaboration	Outstanding feedback; references describe the firm as a trusted advisor	____

Raw score (sum of sub-criteria) _____ / 20 **District weight** _____ % **Weighted score** = raw ÷ 20 × weight _____

NOTES / EVIDENCE

Criterion 9: Outcomes, Evaluation & Continuous Improvement

Sub-criterion	1 — Does Not Meet	2 — Partially Meets	3 — Meets	4 — Exceeds	5 — Outstanding	Score
9A. Approach to measuring success (non-academic)	No outcome measurement, or relies on test score claims	Vague outcome language; no measurement framework	Some outcome measures; some focus on utilization and perception	Clear framework using appropriate measures: utilization, educator adoption, instructional practice, perception	Comprehensive post-occupancy evaluation: specific tools, timelines, and stakeholder feedback loops	____
9B. Evidence of learning from prior projects	No evidence of post-occupancy evaluation or iteration	Limited evidence; mentions visiting completed projects	Describes learning from past projects; some iteration	Clear learning loop; examples of how prior findings improved later projects	Systematic improvement process; documented examples of evaluation changing their approach	____

Raw score (sum of sub-criteria) _____ / 10 **District weight** _____ % **Weighted score** = raw ÷ 10 × weight _____

NOTES / EVIDENCE

Score Summary — Individual Evaluator

After completing all nine criteria, transfer your scores here. The committee chair compiles individual scorecards to arrive at consensus scores.

Criterion	Sub-criteria	Max Raw	Raw Score	District Weight	Weighted Score (Raw ÷ Max × Weight)
1. Experience & Past Performance	4	20	____	____ %	____
2. Educational / Learning Environment Approach	3	15	____	____ %	____
3. Stakeholder Engagement & Discovery	3	15	____	____ %	____
4. Design & Planning Methodology	3	15	____	____ %	____
5. Implementation & Project Management	4	20	____	____ %	____
6. Budget, Cost Transparency & Value	3	15	____	____ %	____
7. Product Sourcing & Procurement Transparency	3	15	____	____ %	____
8. Partnership, Governance & Communication	4	20	____	____ %	____
9. Outcomes, Evaluation & Continuous Improvement	2	10	____	____ %	____
Total	**29**	**145**	—	**100%**	**____ / 100**

Evaluator Recommendation

Summarize the evidence behind your scores and record your recommendation before the consensus meeting.

Key strengths	Key concerns or gaps

Evaluator recommendation	Product sourcing and vendor disclosure reviewed?	Evaluator signature and date
☐ Advance to finalist interviews	☐ Yes — complete, no significant conflicts	Signature: _____
☐ Do not advance	☐ Yes — conflicts disclosed (noted in Criterion 7)	Date: _____
☐ Advance with reservations (explain in notes)	☐ Missing, incomplete, or unclear	

Guide for District Weight-Setting

Before issuing your solicitation, your committee must agree on the weight for each criterion and disclose the weights to all proposers. Weights cannot change after the solicitation is issued.

Weight-Setting Process

1. Convene your evaluation committee before the RFQ or RFP is issued
2. Each committee member independently assigns weights to the nine criteria (each member's weights must total 100%)
3. Discuss individual assignments and reach consensus weights
4. Document the agreed weights in a dated, signed committee record
5. Publish the agreed weights in the solicitation — they are binding
6. Do not adjust weights after proposals are received

Factors That Should Influence Your Weighting

Project factor	Consider weighting higher	Consider weighting lower	Notes
First-time LSI engagement	Criteria 1, 3, 8	Criterion 9	District has less basis for evaluating an outcomes track record
Large multi-building program	Criteria 5, 8	Criterion 4	Implementation and governance become critical at scale
Limited budget / tight constraints	Criteria 6, 7	Criterion 2	Cost management and procurement transparency matter more
District in active instructional transformation	Criteria 2, 3	Criteria 6, 7	Vision alignment and discovery process are most critical
Significant accessibility needs / inclusion focus	Criterion 2	Criterion 1	Look for universal design competency specifically
Strong existing vendor relationships	Criterion 7	—	Procurement transparency is more important to evaluate carefully

What Makes a Scoring Decision Defensible

A selection is defensible when any qualified observer — the superintendent, school board, purchasing director, legal counsel, a competing firm, or a state auditor — can answer yes to each of these questions:

- ☐ Were the criteria and weights published before proposals were received?
- ☐ Did every proposer receive the same information, questions, and timeline?
- ☐ Did every evaluator complete and sign a conflict of interest certification?
- ☐ Were proposals scored independently before committee discussion?
- ☐ Do the written notes explain why each criterion was scored the way it was?
- ☐ Was the highest-scoring firm selected — or, if not, is there a documented and defensible reason?
- ☐ Were all non-selected firms notified in writing?

If any answer is no, consult your district's purchasing director or legal counsel before proceeding.